

McLeod Tools V1.2 Documentation



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Version 1.2

Overview

McLeod Tools is a command-line interface (CLI) application developed to improve the management and operation of the McLeod Remote Desktop Connection environment. Designed and developed by **Austin Davis**, the application provides a collection of utilities that allow users to quickly launch, restart, forcefully terminate, and manage productivity tasks associated with the McLeod Remote Desktop client.

Version **1.2** introduces the **Excel Shift Tool**, allowing users to quickly generate standardized shift tracking workbooks for call center operations.

Installation Instructions can be found on Page 5.

Key Features

Application Loader

Launches the McLeod Remote Desktop Connection client.

Application Restarter

Safely closes and relaunches the application to restore functionality.

Force Quit Utility

Immediately terminates the application when it becomes unresponsive or cannot be closed normally.

Excel Shift Tool (New in Version 1.2)

Creates Microsoft Excel workbooks for tracking call center shifts.

Users have two workbook generation options:

- **Shift-Based Workbook**
 - Automatically removes unnecessary columns.
 - Generates hourly time slots based on the selected shift.
 - Includes the following tracking columns:
 - Time
 - Tracking
 - Actions Taken
 - Notes
 - Second Check
- **Untouched-Time Workbook (Option 4)**
 - Generates the same tracking workbook **without** predefined time slots.
 - This option is intended for users who need a fully customizable workbook.
 - Users need to remove or modify dates and time entries as needed after generation.

Command-Line Interface

Provides a lightweight, scriptable solution that can be integrated into automation workflows, administrative scripts, and support tools.

Standalone Executable

Distributed as a compiled Windows executable, eliminating the need for a local Python installation while maintaining the flexibility of the original Python implementation.

Design and Development

McLeod Tools was engineered with a focus on simplicity, reliability, and ease of deployment.

Originally developed in Python, the application leverages Python's standard libraries for process management, file generation, and Windows system interaction. After development and testing, the application was compiled into a standalone Windows executable, allowing deployment without requiring Python to be installed on the target workstation.

Its modular architecture allows additional utilities and commands to be incorporated as operational requirements evolve, making it a scalable solution for future enhancements.

Purpose

McLeod Tools is designed to simplify common troubleshooting and administrative tasks by reducing the number of manual steps required to recover from application freezes, connection issues, or unresponsive Remote Desktop sessions.

Version 1.2 expands this functionality by providing automated Excel workbook generation for call center shift documentation, reducing manual spreadsheet setup and ensuring consistent reporting across shifts.

Benefits

McLeod Tools provides several operational benefits:

- Reduces downtime caused by frozen or unresponsive Remote Desktop sessions.
 - Simplifies troubleshooting for IT support personnel and end users.
 - Minimizes manual intervention during application recovery.
 - Supports scripting and automation for repetitive administrative tasks.
 - Generates standardized shift tracking workbooks in seconds.
 - Eliminates repetitive spreadsheet formatting.
 - Offers a portable, self-contained executable that can be deployed without installing Python or additional software.
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Conclusion

McLeod Tools improves reliability, reduces downtime, and provides IT staff and end users with a fast, efficient method for managing the McLeod Remote Desktop Connection application.

With the introduction of the Excel Shift Tool, Version 1.2 expands beyond application management by helping users quickly generate standardized shift documentation, making daily tracking more efficient and consistent.

Technical Specifications

Item	Description
Application Name	McLeod Tools
Developer	Austin Davis
Programming Language	Python
Deployment	Compiled Windows Executable (.exe)
Platform	Microsoft Windows
Interface	Command-Line Interface (CLI)
Purpose	McLeod management, troubleshooting, and Excel workbook generation

System Requirements

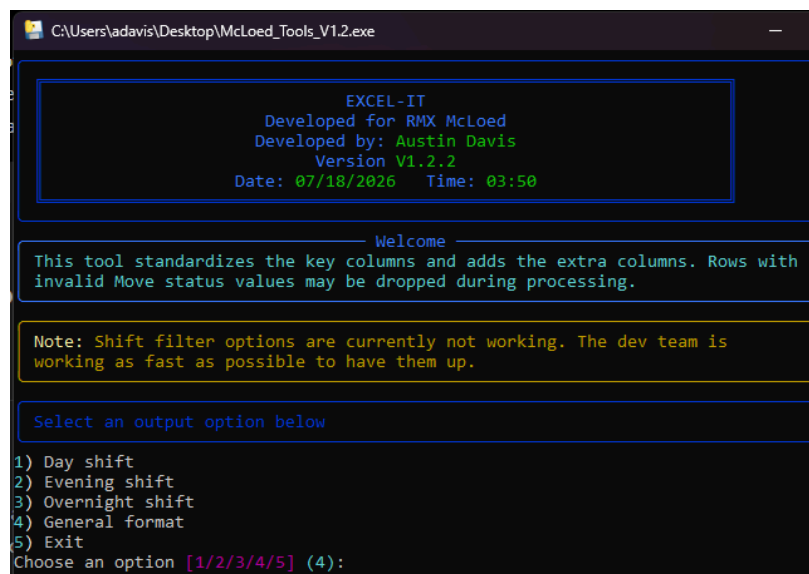
- Microsoft Windows 10 or Windows 11
 - McLeod Remote Desktop Connection client installed
 - Microsoft Excel (for viewing/editing generated workbooks)
 - Command Prompt or PowerShell
 - Appropriate user permissions to manage application processes
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Installation

1. Copy **McLeodTools.exe** to the desired workstation.
2. Launch the application.
3. Open **Option 4 - Settings** from the main menu.
4. Configure the McLeod Remote Desktop file location:
 - Use the Settings menu to browse to the location of the McLeod Remote Desktop package files.
 - Navigate to the **Remote Packages** folder.
 - Select the current production McLeod RDP file:
McLeod_25_Prod.rdp
 - If a newer production RDP file is released in the future, select the latest updated McLeod production **.rdp** file instead.
5. Save the settings and return to the main menu.
6. The tool is now configured and ready for use.

Optional: Add the executable's directory to the system PATH if you would like to launch McLeod Tools from the command line.

Excel Shift Tool - EXCEL-IT



The Excel Shift Tool guides users through creating a standardized workbook for documenting daily shift activities.

Available Options

Option 1–3

- Generate a workbook based on a predefined shift schedule.
- Automatically populates hourly time entries.
- Removes unnecessary columns.
- Includes:
 - Time
 - Tracking
 - Actions Taken
 - Notes
 - Second Check

Option 4

- Generates a blank workbook.
- No predefined time entries are included.
- Intended for users who wish to customize the workbook manually.
- Users may remove or edit dates and time entries as needed.
- Removes unnecessary columns.
- Includes all same columns as options 1-3

Error Handling

The application validates user commands, detects whether the McLeod client is running, and provides informative error messages when operations cannot be completed.

The Excel Shift Tool also validates user selections and prevents invalid workbook generation options from being processed.

Unexpected failures are handled gracefully to minimize disruption.

Future Enhancements

Planned improvements include:

- Enhanced application logging
- Automatic recovery from connection failures
- Configuration file support
- Additional administrative commands
- Improved diagnostics and health monitoring
- Additional Excel workbook templates
- Automatic report generation
- CSV export support

Version History

Version	Description
1.0	Initial Python implementation and standalone Windows executable release.
1.1	Minor improvements, bug fixes, and command enhancements.
1.2	Added the Excel Shift Tool, including shift-based workbook generation, customizable blank workbook option, standardized tracking columns, and improved documentation.

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McLeod Tools

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Online Download At Github.com:

<https://github.com/rolen3343/Mcloed-Tools>